

Beyond the POC Graveyard:

A Playbook for Executive-Led GenAI Transformation





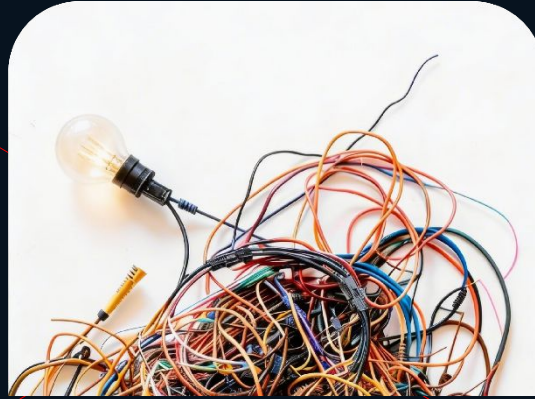
Biase De Gregorio

Head of AI Strategy and Enablement
iqbusiness

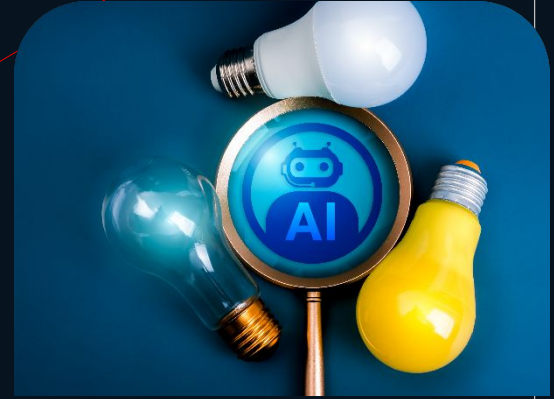
What to Expect?



A repeatable executive engagement pattern



From scattered ideas to a prioritised AI portfolio



Building the foundations to scale GenAI, not just pilot it

Context

Our Holding company:
Large, listed South African industrial group
founded in 1888 and listed on the JSE in
1948

3 Segments

ICT

Information,
Communication
and Technology

EE

Electrical
Engineering

AE

Applied
Electronics

17

Business Units
across the Group

Strategic imperative to drive AI and GenAI across the Group

JUNE 2025

**Demystifying GenAI
workshop with Group
Exco**

SEPTEMBER 2025

**Project
kickoff**

The Scope

Turn AI ambition into Group-wide advantage

6

priority BUs

2 from each BU

12

week strategy increment

GenAI-focused

10

Opportunities per BU

repeatable enablement assets

3+

Group quick wins

repeatable enablement assets

1.

Position each BU on the **Strategic Competitiveness Framework**

2.

Engage BU ExcOs through **demystifying AI workshops**

3.

Assess readiness across IT, talent, governance, data, leadership, and processes

4.

Synthesize insights Group-wide

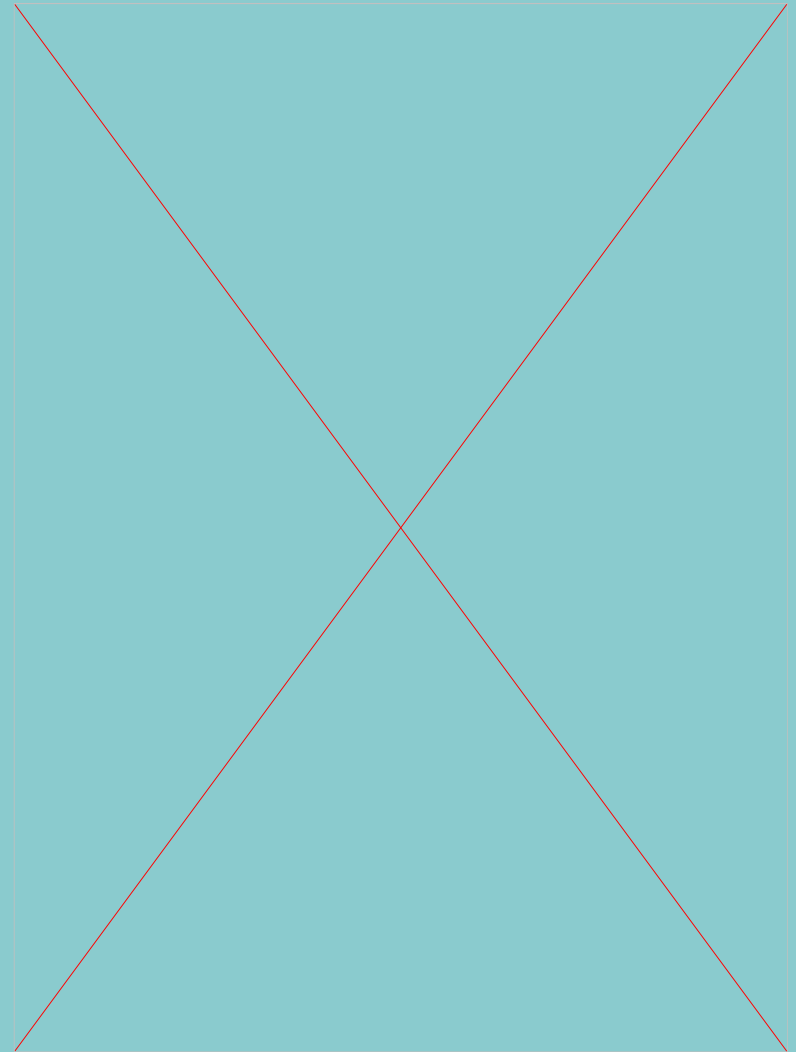
5.

Prioritise projects using clear criteria

6.

Identify and select at least 3 **high-impact** Group quick win projects

Our Approach



Desktop Strategy Review

(Segment-level first)

Build the segment view, validate the lens, then sequence BU engagement.

Strategic competitiveness lens



Segment executives validate the process, shape BU sequencing and bring governance into the review.



01 Map current vs future BU position

Cost vs differentiation lens



02 Confirm segment emphasis

Cost Champion or Differentiation Leader



03 Validate process with Segment Exco

Process and expectations aligned



04 Build BU baseline profiles

Use documents and segment input



05 Apply governance and choose BU cohort

Central compliance protocol included



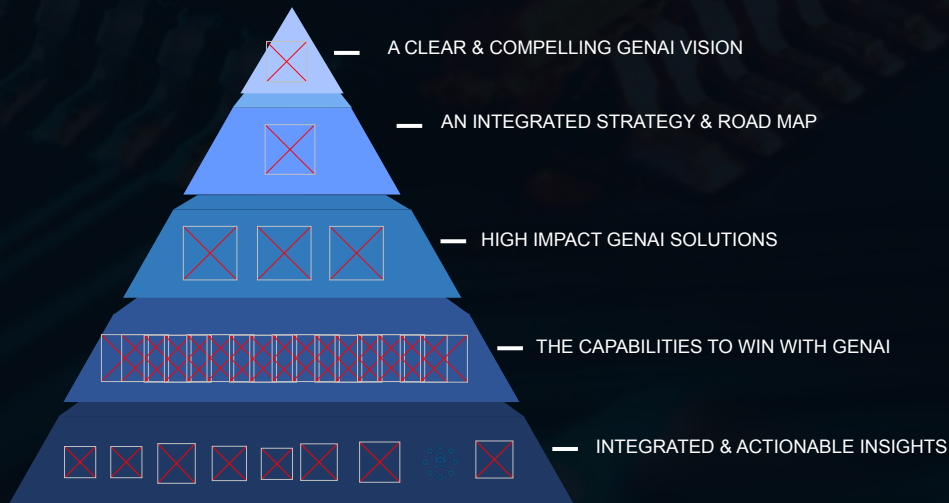
06 Issue pre-read and workshop invite

De-Mystifying AI / Strategic Use of AI

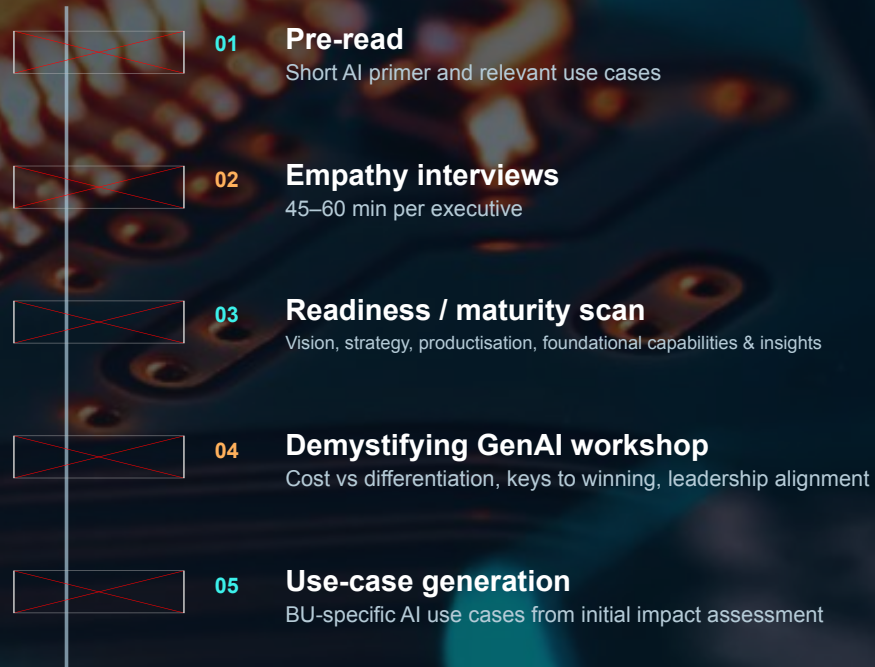
Demystifying GenAI Workshops with BU ExcOs

Purpose: Prime the BU, surface executive pain points, assess readiness and frame high-value AI use cases.

5 Readiness lenses



Workshop flow



Consolidation and Round-up

Group-wide synthesis

Connect the dots across the Group



Pockets of expertise

Identify cross-BU strengths and specialist capability



Current initiatives

Catalogue AI and analytics work already underway or planned



Capability mapping

Understand each BU's aspiration, intent and delivery capacity



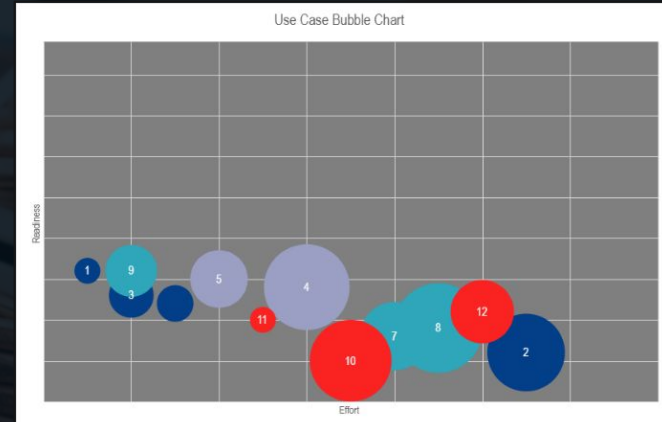
Leverage points

Spot common opportunities for economies of scale

Overlap, consolidate, scale.

Opportunity identification

Per-BU output consolidation



Basic prioritisation - CoD

Highest impact • Time to implement • BU readiness

Key findings / insights

Compelling GenAI use cases exist across the BUs. Readiness and maturity to scale them is low.

Compelling use cases $\neq$ scalable execution

The constraint is not finding valuable use cases. It is the organisational capability to deliver and scale them.



Leadership alignment

No shared BU awareness to create momentum for a centrally coordinated approach



Readiness gaps

Literacy, data quality, governance and technical capability remain weak



Siloed GenAI adoption

Understanding and use of GenAI is inconsistent and BU-led, not coordinated



Engineering capability exists

Pockets of expertise are available and can be enabled at Group level, but only through coordinated enablement



Risk exposure is growing

AI tools are already in use without coordinated security or governance

Phase I Outcomes: Foundation for Execution and Scaling established

Summary of achievements

- ✓ Demystifying AI workshops completed across 6 selected BUs
- ✓ Business and AI readiness assessments completed
- ✓ Multiple potential use cases identified per BU

Readiness to
execute

Opportunity for measurable
early wins

Select
3 pilot BUs

Strength of
identified use cases

Balanced across Segments and BUs
aligned to Group priorities

Approval to continue with Phase II

Targeted use case delivery will scale foundational capabilities through a repeatable and consistent pattern.

Next steps

PHASE II OBJECTIVES

One coordinated execution path across Group governance, BU delivery and capability scaling

1

PRIORITY 1

Portfolio level framework

Accelerate portfolio performance while systematically de-risking AI adoption by co-creating a targeted Group Governing and Scaling Framework.

2

PRIORITY 2

Co-build selected “AI use case”

Deliver near-term outcomes and build BU-led capability through the AI-Native Solution Blueprint: discovery, design, viability assessment and incremental delivery.

3

PRIORITY 3

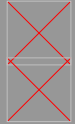
Capability accelerator

Accelerate capability and maturity by embedding the team in live delivery contexts spanning Group governance design, AI-Native solution delivery and capability scaling.

Standardise Governing and Scaling Framework (Portfolio Engine)



1



2



3

1

Use case intake and objective scoring model

2

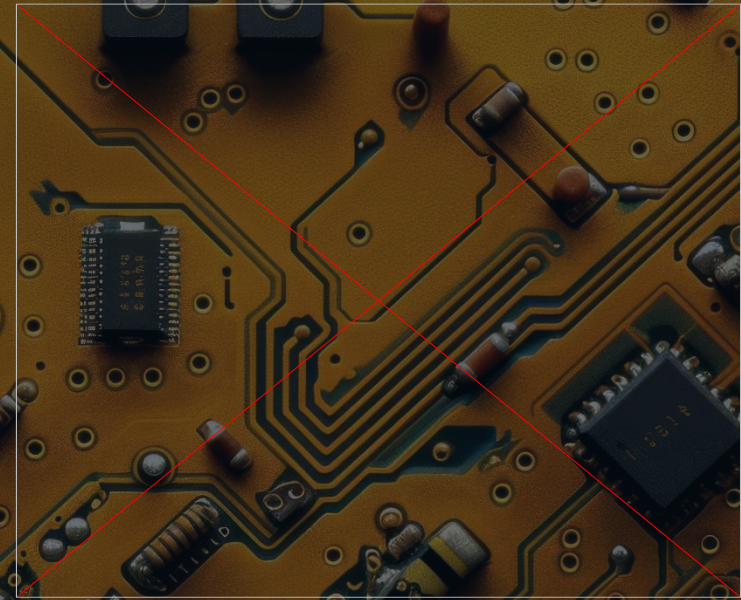
Decision rights, prioritisation and funding signals

3

Tiered evidence gates (Secure AI, Responsible AI, operational readiness)

4

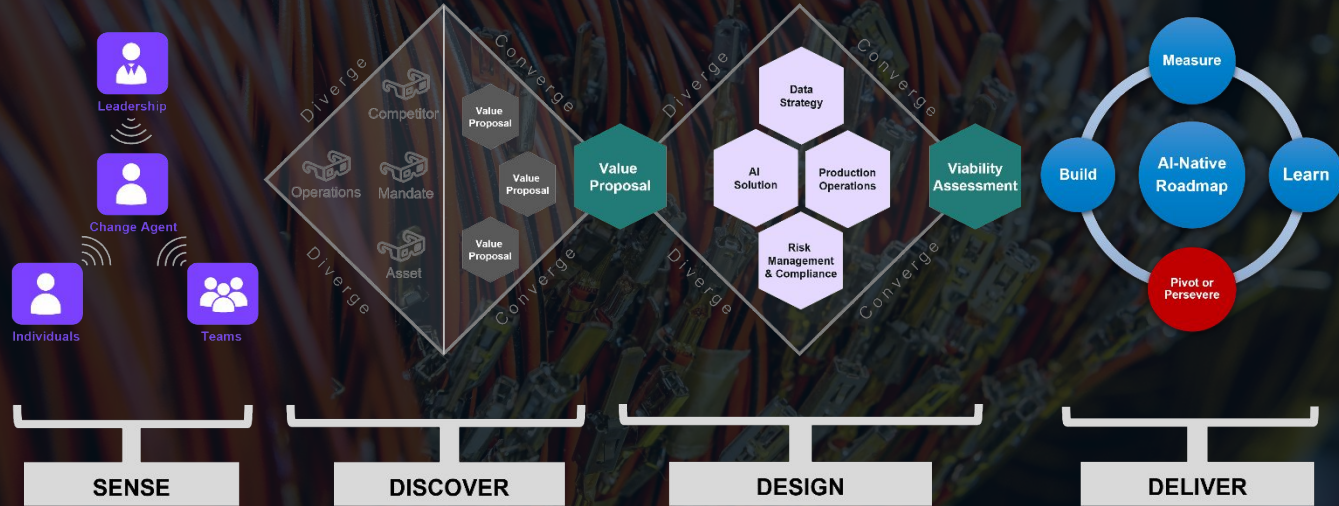
Steering cadence and portfolio visibility



Outcome: AI managed as a repeatable Group capability

AI-Native Applied Solution Delivery

Deliver measurable wins within 60–90 days, using structured delivery lenses



Outcome: Solutions embedded into real workflows, not prototypes

Capability Scaling Blueprints (Enable Scale, Remove Bottlenecks)

Accelerate capability and maturity through applied co-delivery for each Pilot Business Unit



1



2



3

ENABLING GOVERNANCE AND OPERATIONAL INTEGRITY

Secure AI



Responsible AI



Integrated
change Mgmt.



Integrated
Governance



MATURING FOUNDATIONAL GENAI CAPABILITIES

GenAI Ready
Data



LLM
Selection



Foundational
Orchestration



Evaluation as a
service



GenAI
UX Design



LLMOps & GenAI
Operations



IMPLEMENTING SCALING CAPABILITIES

Talent
development



GenAI Centre of
Excellence



GenAI Brand
Building



Integrated product
Economics Analytics



ADOPTING ADVANCED GENAI CAPABILITIES

Applied AI and
ML expertise



Enterprise
Knowledge graphs



Intelligent
Orchestration



Hyper-
Personalisation



Model training
and fine-tuning



Agentic AI



Outcome: Removes blockers and enables repeatable delivery across Business Units

How will we achieve this?

Winning fast while building for sustainable growth.

Delta7/28™

Δ7
(Weekly Boost)

Quick Wins

*Deliver tangible GenAI
value every 7 days
Real outcomes teams
can see, feel, and
measure.*



Boost

Product Wins

Δ28
(Monthly Accelerators)

Structural Scale

*Every 28 days, advance
foundational scale
Build your talent bench
and configure your
insights portal.*

Accelerate

Foundational Wins

*Together, Δ7 + Δ28 create a
dual rhythm for leadership
control.*

Win while you build:
short-term results that prove
value fast.

Build while you win:
closing gaps and configuring
your control system for
sustainable scale.

Lessons learnt

Five lessons that stand out

1

Most leaders want to start but are not sure where to start with GenAI.

EDGE

2

Most leaders want to just go and build GenAI solutions.

Hype vs reality

3

Start with their keys to winning and business outcomes.

AI Value gap

4

Apply a standardised approach to building GenAI solutions to avoid the PoC graveyard.

AI-Native Solution Blueprint

5

Determine the right way to enter and apply a flexible approach.

Flexible entry

IT'S NOT ONLY ABOUT

STRATEGY

SOLUTIONS

FOUNDATIONAL
CAPABILITIES

THANK YOU

Please rate this session!

